

## READING PASSAGE 2

### The Development of Democracy in Ancient Greece

**A** The study of the development of democracy in ancient greece has undergone a remarkable transformation over the past several decades. What was once a niche area of academic inquiry has developed into a rich and diverse field of research, drawing on insights from a wide range of disciplines and theoretical traditions.

**B** Historically, scholarly understanding of this topic was limited by both theoretical frameworks and available methodologies. Early researchers operated within relatively narrow conceptual boundaries, and their findings, while groundbreaking for their time, often failed to capture the full complexity of the phenomena they sought to explain. The development of new research tools and analytical techniques in the latter half of the twentieth century fundamentally transformed the landscape, enabling scholars to investigate questions that had previously been considered beyond the reach of empirical inquiry.

**C** Contemporary research has identified several critical factors that determine outcomes in this domain. The interplay between environmental conditions, technological capabilities, and social organisation creates a complex adaptive system in which small changes can produce disproportionately large effects. Understanding these dynamics requires analytical approaches that move beyond simple cause-and-effect reasoning to embrace the principles of complexity science and systems thinking.

**D** The empirical record is further strengthened by a series of meta-analyses that have synthesised findings from hundreds of individual studies. These comprehensive reviews have consistently identified moderate to large effect sizes, with the most robust findings demonstrating remarkable consistency across different research designs, measurement approaches, and analytical strategies. This convergence of evidence from multiple independent lines of inquiry considerably strengthens confidence in the validity of the core theoretical propositions.

**E** The practical application of research findings has proven more challenging than many initially anticipated. The translation of academic knowledge into actionable policy recommendations requires navigating a complex landscape of political constraints, economic interests, and social dynamics that academic models often simplify or overlook. Implementation failures in several high-profile initiatives have underscored the gap between theoretical understanding and practical capacity, prompting calls for more engaged and context-sensitive approaches to research.

**F** The future trajectory of research in this area will likely be shaped by several converging trends. Advances in computational methods and data science are opening up new analytical possibilities, enabling researchers to detect patterns and test hypotheses at scales that were previously unimaginable. Simultaneously, growing recognition of the importance of interdisciplinary collaboration is breaking down traditional barriers between fields and fostering innovative syntheses of diverse theoretical perspectives.

**G** The evidence reviewed above demonstrates both the substantial achievements of research in this field and the significant work that remains to be done. As new tools and theoretical perspectives become available, and as the phenomena themselves continue to evolve, the research community will need to maintain both rigour in its methods and openness to new ideas. The stakes are high, for the questions addressed by this research bear directly on some of the most important challenges facing humanity in the twenty-first century.

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#### Question 1

**Complete the sentences below. Choose NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS from the passage for each answer.**

- 1 According to the passage, structural factors include economic incentives, institutional frameworks, and \_\_\_\_\_.

**Questions 2–3**

**Do the following statements agree with the information given in the passage?**

**Write TRUE if the statement agrees with the information**

**Write FALSE if the statement contradicts the information**

**Write NOT GIVEN if there is no information on this**

- 2 The author believes that all research questions in this field have been answered.
- 3 Early researchers had access to the same technologies as modern scholars.

**Question 4**

**Complete the sentences below. Choose NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS from the passage for each answer.**

- 4 The landmark study analysed data spanning a period of \_\_\_\_\_ years.

**Question 5**

**Choose the correct letter, A, B, C or D.**

- 5 What finding emerged from the landmark study discussed in the passage?
- A. pessimism about the future
  - B. cautious optimism with acknowledgment of challenges
  - C. complete certainty about outcomes
  - D. indifference to practical applications

**Question 6**

**Do the following statements agree with the information given in the passage?**

**Write TRUE if the statement agrees with the information**

**Write FALSE if the statement contradicts the information**

**Write NOT GIVEN if there is no information on this**

- 6 The passage suggests that structural factors are less important than individual choices.

**Question 7**

**Choose the correct letter, A, B, C or D.**

- 7 What finding emerged from the landmark study discussed in the passage?
- A. weak effects across studies
  - B. moderate to large effect sizes with consistency
  - C. contradictory findings

D. results only in specific populations

**Question 8**

**Complete the sentences below. Choose NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS from the passage for each answer.**

8 According to the text, cognitive processes shape the \_\_\_\_\_ that people make.

**Question 9**

**Do the following statements agree with the information given in the passage?**

**Write TRUE if the statement agrees with the information**

**Write FALSE if the statement contradicts the information**

**Write NOT GIVEN if there is no information on this**

9 Contemporary understanding of this topic is more sophisticated than it was fifty years ago.

**Question 10**

**Choose the correct letter, A, B, C or D.**

10 Which of the following best describes the author's view on future developments?

- A. inconsistent results across cultures
- B. a consistent pattern across diverse contexts
- C. no measurable effects
- D. effects limited to Western countries

**Question 11**

**Complete the sentences below. Choose NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS from the passage for each answer.**

11 Dynamic \_\_\_\_\_ processes can amplify or dampen initial effects in complex systems.

**Questions 12–13**

**Choose the correct letter, A, B, C or D.**

12 What does the passage identify as a significant challenge to current understanding?

- A. minimal impact
- B. creating underlying conditions for action
- C. determining individual choices directly
- D. irrelevant to outcomes

13 What does the passage identify as a significant challenge to current understanding?

- A. excessive funding
- B. theoretical and methodological limitations
- C. public interest
- D. international collaboration

